essentials. Phones are taken, watches removed, wallets banished, all food thrown away. Steven Finn is brutally stripped of his Haribo, and no, he can't have them back, no matter how politely he asks. They take us further into the depths of the Bavarian Forest, not a sweet in sight, in complete silence.

The middle of the wilderness submerges us as we trudge through it, muttering to each other about what this has to do with cricket – a season that was intense enough having only just finished – nothing but dense woodland for miles and miles in every direction. By the time we stop, the penny's starting to drop with everyone, even Swanny, that this isn't going to involve alcohol of any description, as they line us up and tell us that they are there to 'break us down collectively and individually'. The groans disappear and, in their place, there is a triggered sense of shock. We are divided randomly into four groups, all of us from now on named by our surnames only (Flower liked to name us by our surnames anyway).Tents are divided between us, where in each group we are set the task of building them as night falls. For five days, we are woken up in the torrential rain at 2am, screamed at, no first names used and sent to brutal group tasks.

Everything is orientated around symbolic bricks. We are asked to hold them at arm's length until the whole group is screaming, begging for mercy. We are doing push-ups off them. We have to carry them with us at all times, rucksacks full of them as we hike through ravines, run up hills. If anybody makes a mistake, complains or does a task wrong, they are screamed at to 'drop and do fifty'. There are a lot of fifties. A lot of screaming. Steven Finn, when told that the whole group will have to stay in plank position, a whole night's worth of equipment on our backs until he finishes his, lifts himself by screaming, 'I want to fucking kill you!' We are pushing cars up hills, doing group orienteering, not a bat or ball in sight. All of the activities depend upon the whole group to complete. Whoever is struggling the most always has to be helped, has to force themselves through. I've never heard 'pain is weakness leaving the body' more times. A lot of weakness leaves the body. It's not about being best friends, it's not about having a great time together, it's about building trust and dependency on each other. It's about relying on the other to survive. It's fierce and unrelenting and in time, those who are really struggling have to work out a way to push themselves through and find a way to get themselves to a place where their body